Unit 8

Two Independent Voices

New: A left-hand melody against the right hand: contrary and parallel motion

Until now the left hand has accompanied: it held notes or played chord patterns. Now it plays a real melody of its own, a second voice. Each hand has its own rhythm and its own direction, and the two voices fit together beat by beat. Music written like this, with independent lines, is called counterpoint.

What is new

Contrary motion

One hand goes up while the other goes down. It is the easiest motion to read: the hands move like a mirror.

Parallel and oblique motion

Parallel: both hands move the same way, often a third or sixth apart. Oblique: one hand holds a note while the other moves.

How the voices fit

On the main beats the two hands sound a third, sixth, fifth or octave apart. A note that clashes falls between the beats, on the way from one note to the next.

Read down, then across

Look at both staves on beat 1 of each bar, then follow each line. In Part B the tune is in the left hand; let it sing louder than the right.

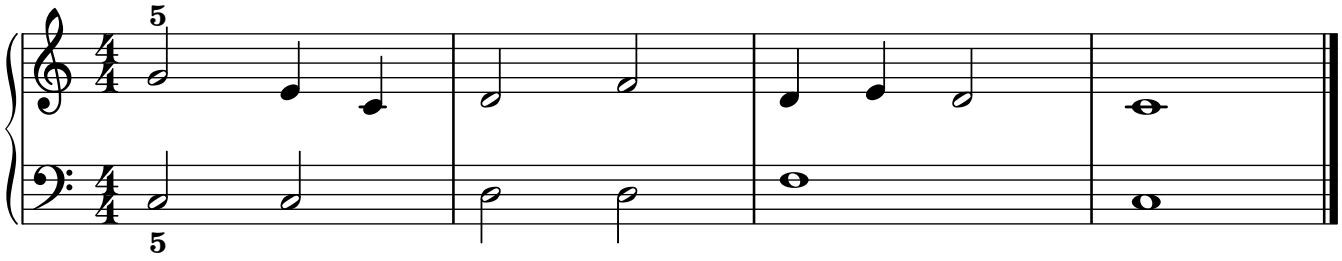
Reading tips

1. Before you start, follow the direction of each hand through the first two bars.
2. Count out loud: two independent rhythms only fit together if the beat is steady.
3. If one hand has long notes, keep them held for their full length while the other hand moves.

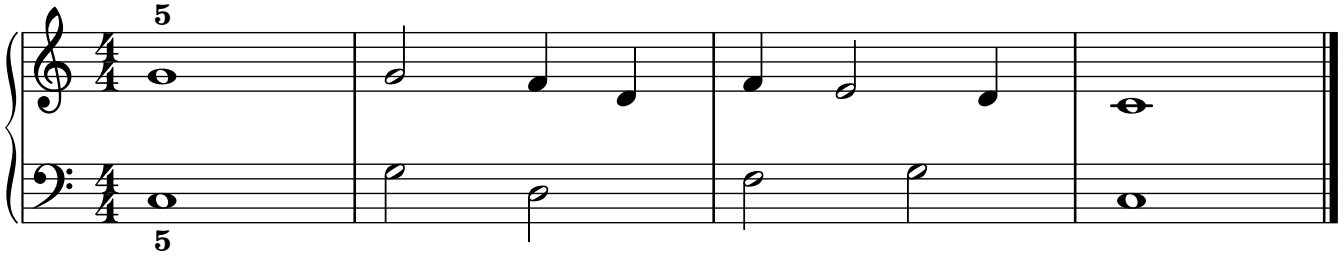
Part A: A second voice in the left hand ♩ = 60

The right hand has the tune; the left hand answers in half notes, often moving the other way.

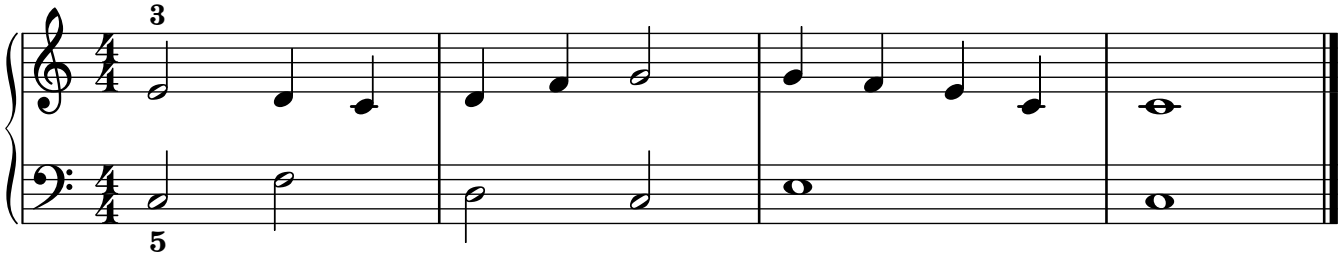
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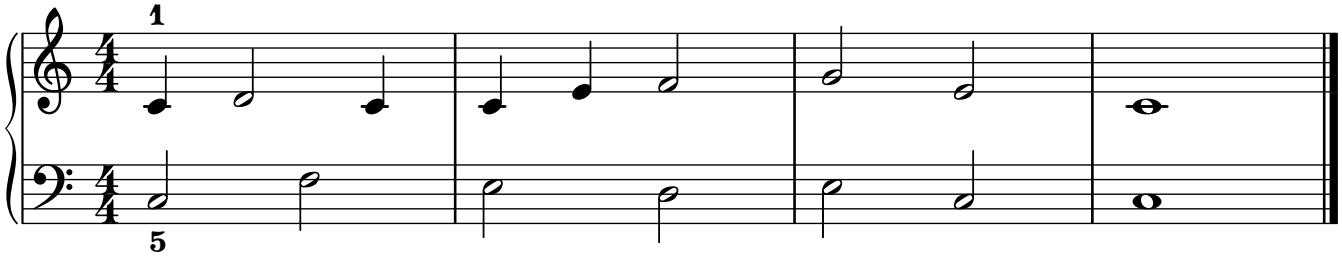
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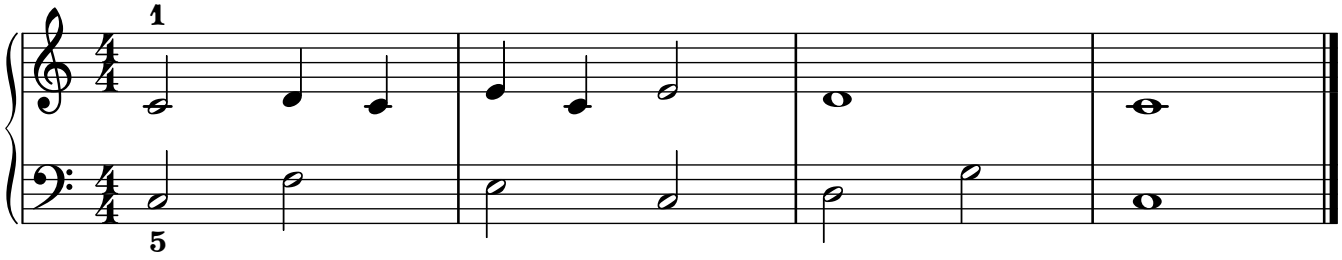
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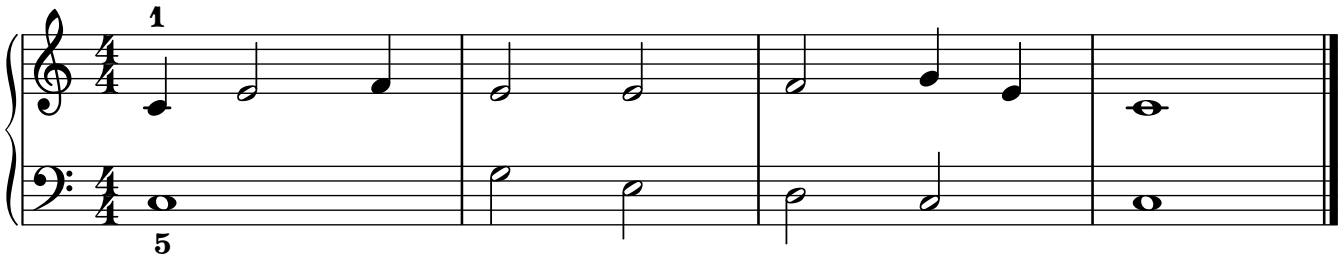
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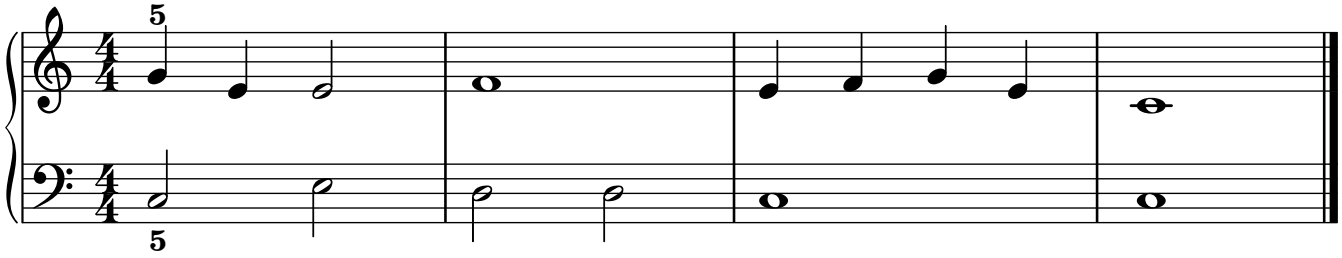
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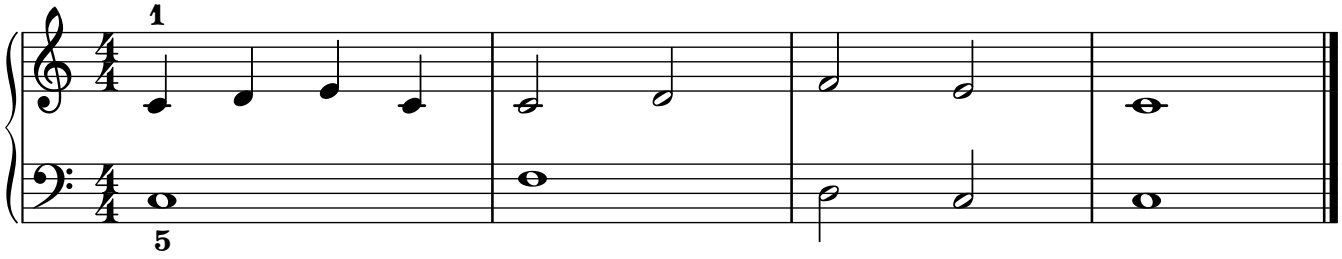
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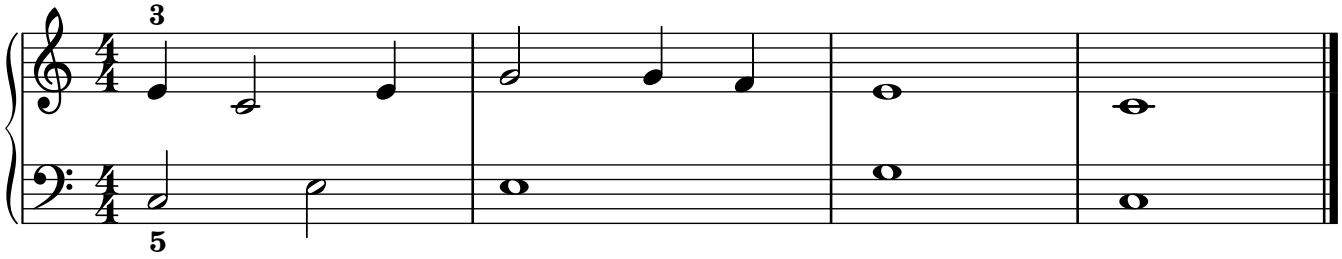
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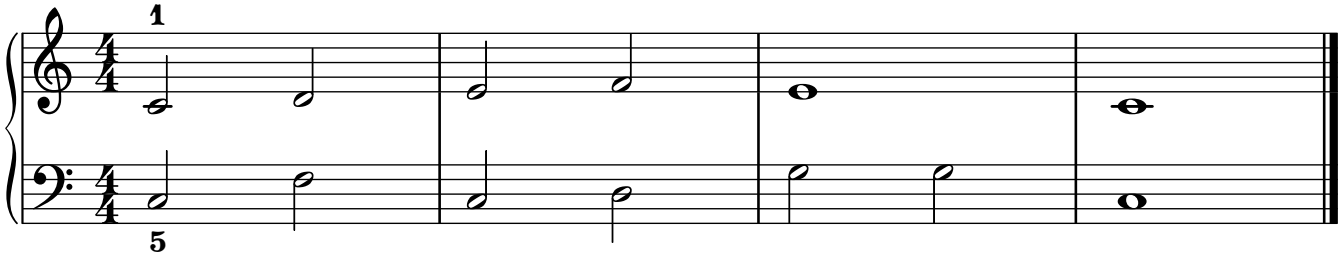
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☐ **8.9**



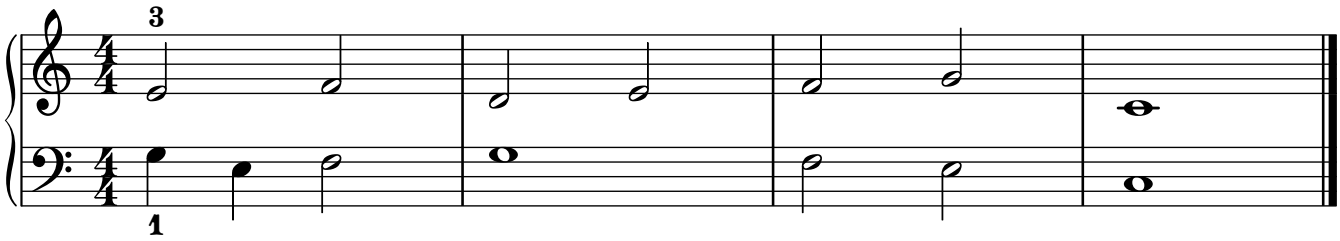
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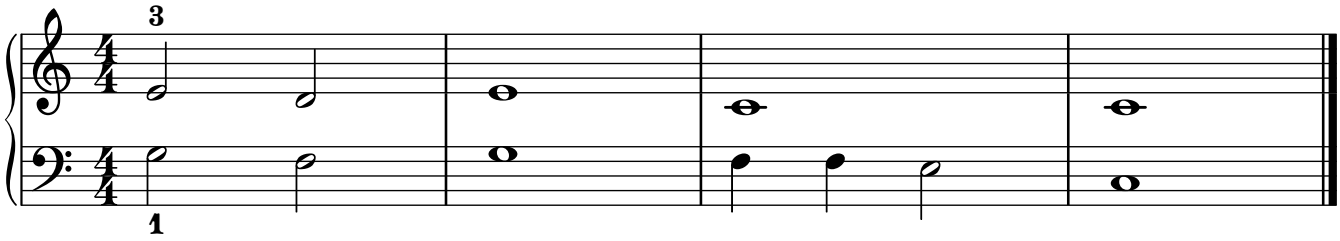
Part B: The tune in the left hand ♩= 60

The tune is in the left hand. The right hand plays long notes above it.

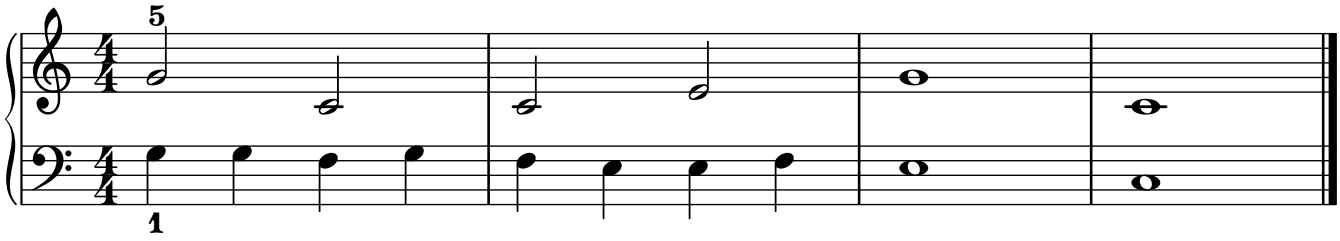
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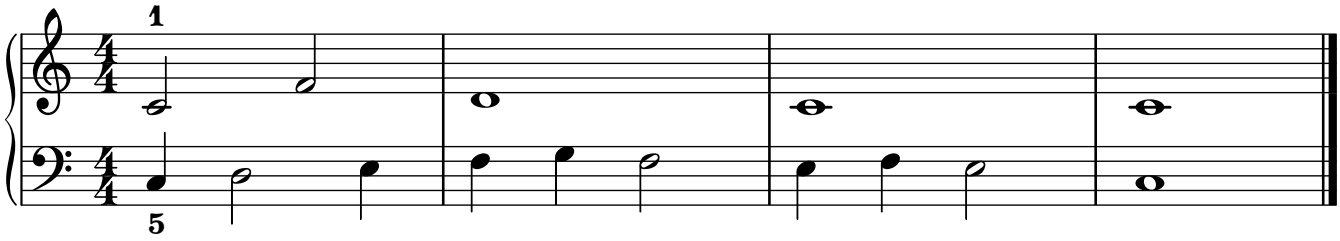
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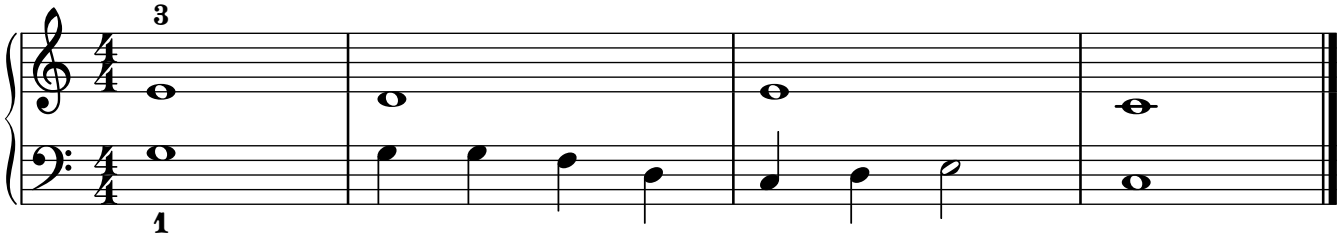
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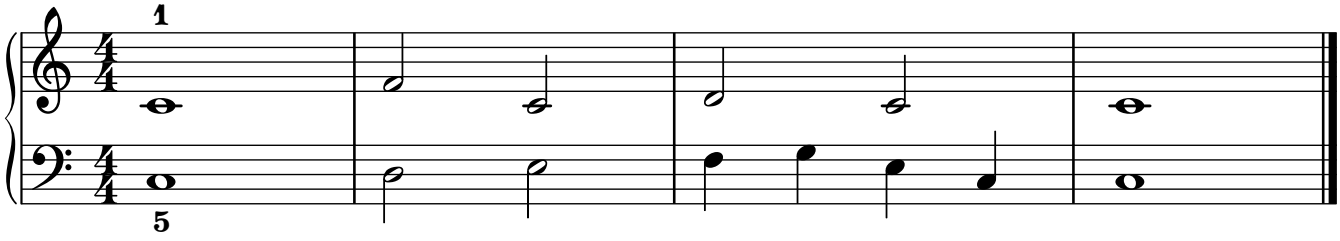
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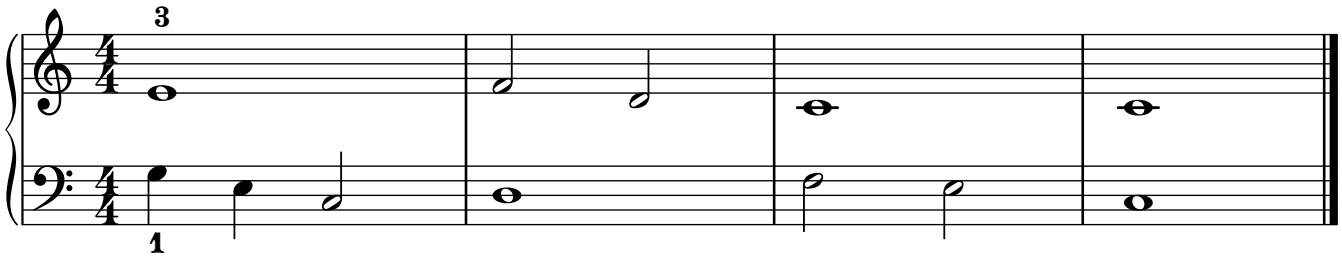
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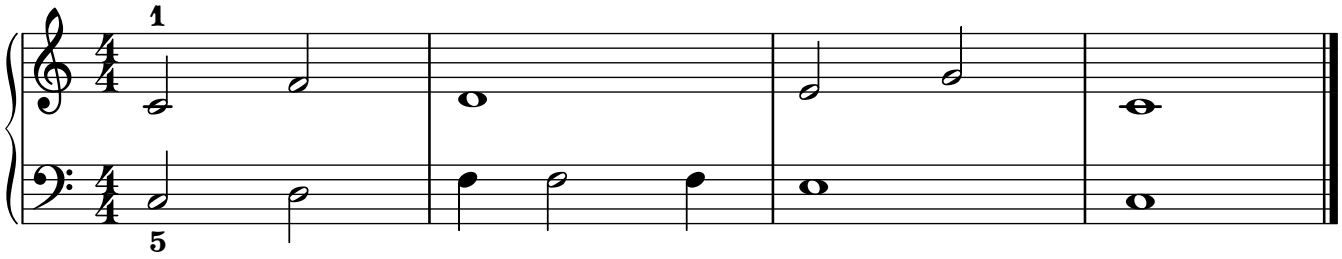
☐ **8.16**



8.17



8.18



Part C: Two voices in 3/4 ♩= 72

Two voices in G major, in 3/4. The left hand moves in quarter and half notes.

☐ **8.19**



☐ **8.20**



8.21



8.22



8.23



8.24



8.25



8.26



Part D: Quarter against quarter ♩ = 60

Both hands in quarter notes: real two-part writing in F major.

☐ **8.27**



☐ **8.28**



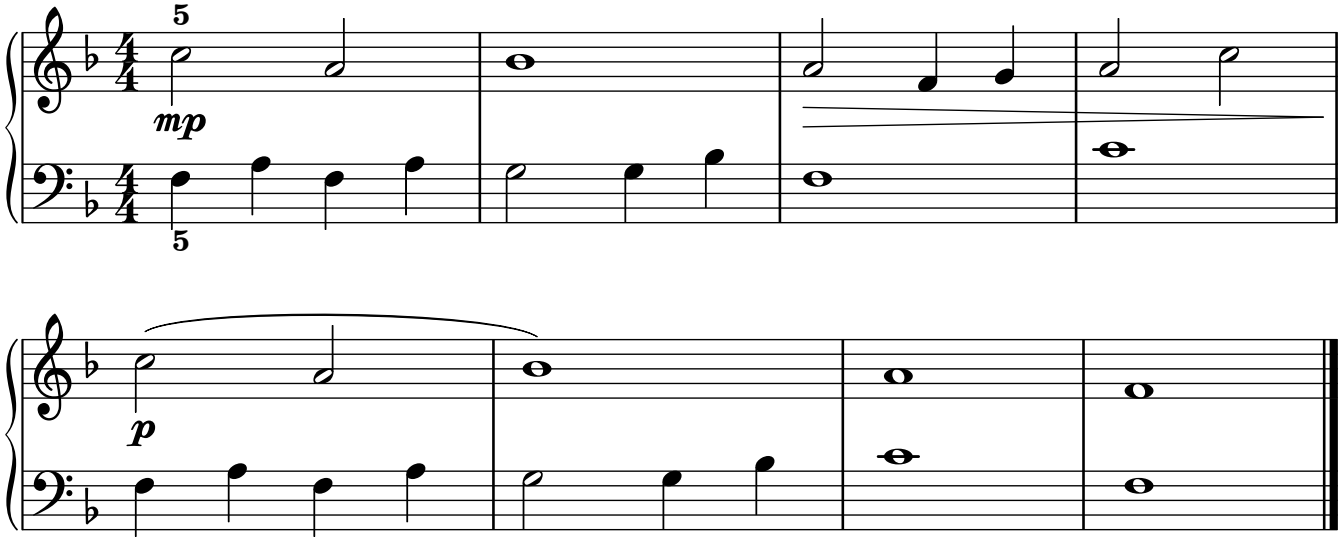
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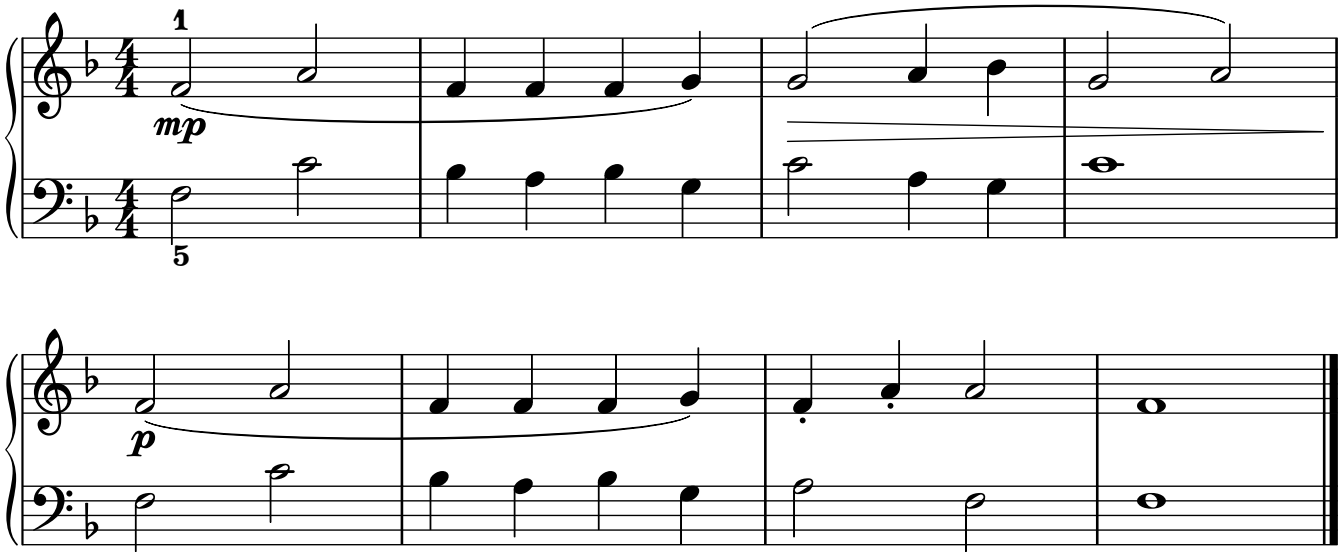
8.30



8.31



8.32



8.33



8.34



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy in Two Voices ♩ = 72

Ludwig van Beethoven, theme from Symphony No. 9 - with an added second voice

The tune from Unit 1, now with a left-hand melody in half notes instead of broken chords. In bar 1 the hands move apart: the right hand climbs while the left hand falls.



Mirror Talk ♩ = 72

Original

Quarter notes in both hands, mostly in contrary motion: when the right hand steps up, the left hand steps down. Both hands are in C position; the left hand stretches finger 5 down to B in bar 4.



The Cellist ♩ = 80

Original

The tune is in the left hand, low like a cello. Let it sing; the right hand holds quiet notes above.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 9?

- Play five new exercises from Parts B to D at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Both lines are clear: long notes are held, and the tune sings in whichever hand has it.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 9.